Foolproof Pan Pizza

Main dishes | Oven

Before you start

Makes two 10-inch pies, serving 4-6. Rest dough 8-24 hours, then 2 hours in oiled pans. Bake at 550°F for 12-15 minutes.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Dough flour, salt, yeast, water, and oil

- [ ] 400 grams (14 ounces, about 2 1/2 cups) bread flour [Bowl A]
- [ ] 10 grams (.35 ounces, about 2 teaspoons) kosher salt, plus more for sprinkling [Bowl A]
- [ ] 4 grams (.15 ounces, about 1/2 teaspoon) instant yeast [Bowl A]
- [ ] 275 grams (9.5 ounces, about 1 cup plus 3 tablespoons) water [Bowl A]
- [ ] 8 grams (.25 ounces, about 2 teaspoons) extra-virgin olive oil, plus more to coat pans and drizzle [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 1/2 cups pizza sauce, such as our New York-style pizza sauce
- [ ] 12 ounces grated full-fat, dry mozzarella cheese (see note above)
- [ ] Toppings as desired
- [ ] Small handful torn fresh basil leaves (optional)
- [ ] 2 ounces grated parmesan or pecorino Romano cheese (optional)

1. Prepare and cook

1. Mix 400 g bread flour, 10 g kosher salt, 4 g instant yeast, 275 g water, and 8 g olive oil in a bowl large enough to hold 4-6 times the dough volume. Mix until no dry flour remains.

2. Cover bowl tightly with plastic wrap, making sure that edges are well-sealed, then let rest on the countertop for at least 8 hours and up to 24. Dough should rise dramatically and fill bowl.

3. Sprinkle the top of the dough lightly with flour, then transfer it to a well-floured work surface. Divide dough into two pieces and form each into a ball by holding it with well-floured hands and tucking the dough underneath itself, rotating it until it forms a tight ball.

4. Pour 1 to 2 tablespoons of oil in the bottom of two 10-inch cast iron skillet or round cake pans. (See note above). Place 1 ball of dough in each pan and turn to coat evenly with oil. Using a flat palm, press the dough around the pan, flattening it slightly and spreading oil around the entire bottom and edges of the pan. Cover tightly with plastic wrap and let the dough sit at room temperature for two hours. After the first hour, adjust an oven rack to the middle position and preheat oven to 550°F.

5. After two hours, dough should be mostly filling in the pan up to the edges. Use your fingertips to press it around until it fills in every corner, popping any large bubbles that appear. Lift up one edge of the dough to let any air bubbles underneath escape and repeat, moving around the dough until there are no air bubbles left underneath and the dough is evenly spread around the pan.

6. Top each of the 2 dough rounds with 3/4 cup pizza sauce and 6 oz shredded mozzarella (1 1/2 cups sauce and 12 oz cheese total), reaching the edges. Season with salt to taste; add desired toppings, an olive oil drizzle, and optional torn basil.

7. Bake 12-15 minutes until golden and bubbly on top and crisp underneath. Sprinkle the optional 2 oz grated Parmesan or Pecorino Romano across the two pizzas. If the bases need more crisping, cook each pan over medium stovetop heat 1-3 minutes, moving it for even browning. Transfer to a board, cut each into 6 slices, and serve.